

CV of Failures

Javier Gonzalez — Updated as of 2026-05-20

“Most of what I try fails, but these failures are often invisible, while the successes are visible.”

An interviewee on the Freakonomics podcast stated that people often see the tech stars at their top of their careers. However, people fail to understand that they needed to take innumerable small steps to get to the top. Among those small steps, there are several step backs, mistakes, and failures. This CV of Failures is an attempt to provide some perspective on my journey.

I copied this idea, and the quote, from Johannes Haushofer who wrote his CV of failures inspired by Melanie I. Stefan's article.

Academic positions I did not get

**only including positions that I was shortlisted*

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|------|---|
| 2026 | Assitant Professor: Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Goverment School, Universidad de los Andes (Colombia)
<i>reached fly-out and no offer</i> |
| 2026 | Assitant Professor: New Economic School (Russia); University Torcuato Di Tella, Business School (Argentina); Univeridad de San Andrés (Argentina)
<i>reached the interview and did not get a fly-out</i> |
| 2026 | Post-Docs: University of Melborne (Australia), Universitu of New South Wales UNSW (Australia)
<i>reached final stage and no offer</i> |
| 2021 | Pre-docs: Chicago's Becker Friendman Institute and Booth School
<i>data task and did not get an interview</i> |

Academic Programs I did not get into

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|------|---|
| 2021 | Ph.D. in Economics: Penn State, University of Michigan, University of Minnesota, Bonn GSE, Zurich GSE, University of Illinois, Barcelona GSE, UC Berkeley, Northwestern, Boston University, University of Toronto, Stockholm University, University of Maryland, NYU, Texas A&M, and University College London
<i>rejected</i> |
| 2021 | Research Masters in Economics: Tilburg University and Tinbergen Institute
<i>rejected</i> |
| 2015 | B.A. in Economics: Universidad de Chile
<i>2nd place in the waiting list</i> |

Awards, scholarships, and fellowships I did not get

2025	SMU O'Donnell Graduate Fellowship
	ACES Gerard Roland Dissertation Fellowship
	NTxEC Best Ph.D. Paper Award
	UniCredit Foundation Econ Job Market Best Paper Award (EU)
2024	SMU Provost's Summer Research Grant

Conferences and summer schools I did not qualify

2024	ACES Summer School in Political Economy
	NBER Digital Economics and Artificial Intelligence
2023	RIDGE Summer School in Economics